

Ads in Facebook's search result

Social media giant Facebook, recently unveils a tool that lets other companies to insert their ads into Facebook's search results.



YouTube's skippable ads

Enjoy watching YouTube videos on your phone without worrying about ads, as it now supports ad skipping <http://dgit.in/Oaz1cP>

Smart SoHo



A screenshot of project management tool Asana

successful Indian crowdfunded projects on Kickstarter right now that have met their targets, so if they can do it so can you. If you don't have an idea yet this could be it – start a Kickstarter clone for India. And if you're feeling super-adventurous you could even post this project on Kickstarter itself.

4. Making sense of social media

Once your venture / startup is off the ground there's no escaping social media. You'll need a presence on the popular social platforms. That's easy – a Twitter account and a Facebook page and you're set. But how do you manage them effectively? That's where tools like <http://hootsuite.com> come in. HootSuite let's you manage multiple social profiles, schedule messages and tweets, track brand mentions, analyze social media traffic.

5. Manage stuff like a boss

Project management or task tracking tools help you focus on the work at hand rather than do tedious operations such as sending status emails, checking up on subordinates and attending non-productive meetings. Asana is one such management tool that lets you quickly capture, organize, track and communicate everything you and your team are working on. It is free for a team size of 30 members. There are other tools out there that have other functionalities integrated such as version control, document management and other collaboration tools such as shared whiteboards. Most of these have free trials. You can take a dip and see which one suits your needs. Some names to give a spin are Basecamp, Trello, TeamBox and Freedcamp.

6. Other tools to help you get by

During the course of your day-to-day business, you'll need certain tools handy to help you get all sorts of functional tasks done. Below are some:

• Surveys

There are times when getting feedback from customers is critical. You may even need to look for responses from other target audiences for service improvement or some kind of quick market research. For such times www.surveymonkey.com is a good option. In the free plan it offers 10 questions per survey and the ability to collect a 100 responses per survey. For more sophisticated needs there are other plans starting approximately at ₹500.

• Jazzy presentations

Sometimes plain old powerpoint presentations just don't cut it when it comes to impressing clients. In such cases use www.prezi.com to come up with fluid, large-scale motion-oriented presentations that are guaranteed to leave your audience spellbound.

• Mass Mailers

Reaching out to your customers is good for business. You may have some product update, some new offer, or maybe you just want to spam their inboxes so that they remember you every now and then. Whatever the reason <http://mailchimp.com> is your weapon of choice. MailChimp helps you design email newsletters, share them on social networks, integrate with services you already use and track your results. The free plan lets you mass-mail 2,000 subscribers and you can send up to 12,000 emails per month absolutely free.

• Accounting

Do you really need Tally for keeping those simple in/out records? Maybe not. To fulfill your simple bookkeeping needs try out www.manager.io a free opensource software for Linux, Windows and Mac. You can create all sorts of invoices, charts from data, and even call up reports from time to time. Online tools such as <http://out-right.com> may work just as well but be warned, these are designed for overseas bookkeeping standards. 

NP AV

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